

Blue Yeti USB Microphone

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ne of the most recognised companies in the USB microphones world, Blue launched the Blue Yeti USB microphone in India this year.

This microphone has already proved to be a popular one amongst podcasters and streamers alike due to its recording capabilities and affordable price tag. The microphone is exceptionally well-built. Sporting a full metal exterior, the microphone comes with a mini-USB port, a headphone jack and a threaded base (which allows you to attach it to any standard mic stand or a shock mount). There's also a volume adjusting knob and an LED-illuminated mute button in the front, and on the back there are two more knobs – a pattern selection knob and a gain knob. We appreciated the addition of a gain knob at this price point, especially since some similarly-priced models do not employ one.



Depending on your use case, you can choose to employ one of four sound capture patterns – cardioid mode for when you're sitting directly in front of it, stereo mode for live music, omnidirectional for round-table conferences, and a two-way pattern for interviews. All four sound capture patterns work decently well for mics in this price range, however, the cardioid mode doesn't filter out as much sound as we'd hope. The USB port on the mic is a Type-A to

Mini-B connector, which is quite uncommon nowadays, and if you were to replace the cable, chances are, you wouldn't have a spare one lying handy.

Setting up the Yeti is a pretty simple and seamless task since you don't have to install any external software during the setup process. It's pretty much plug-and-play which makes it convenient for those who aren't too technically adept. As for quality, the Yeti delivers an impressive performance. Featuring a 16-bit, 28kHz recording sample rate, the microphone's performance is more than adequate for streamers, podcasters, and semi-serious musicians. The sound is not hollow like you'd get from a cheap mic, and sounds pretty natural. Overall, this mid-range microphone is one of the most sought after USB microphones, delivering good performance, decent environmental noise cancelling, and an easy set up process.

PRICE – ₹12,499



ViewSonic X10 4K Smart LED Projector

ViewSonic X10 is a 4K projector with HDR 10 support and highlights like a Bluetooth speaker and Wi-Fi support. The ViewSonic X10 projector is extremely well built. The top of the projector has a gunmetal finish. The front has the lens with a protective glass on top of it. At the back, we have a magnetic cover that keeps the ports covered and protected. Coming to connectivity options, we have the power port, a housing for the Wi-Fi dongle, optical audio out, 3.5mm audio out, 3.5mm audio in, two HDMI ports with HDCP 2.2, one USB-C port, a micro SD slot, LAN port and two USB-A ports one of which is USB 3. However, there is no zoom ring or a focus ring on the projector.

Power on the projector and you are greeted with the Aptoide app store and settings that you can control. The apps from the Aptoide app store gave us a lackluster experience but the overall UI of the projector is very simple to navigate. The projector can display a resolution of 4K and it also supports HDR. The projector claims to feature 125 percent of Rec.709 colour accuracy. Our source of content for this projector was the 4K enabled Fire TV stick and an Xbox One X. The projector boasts of 4K resolution with HDR support. It doesn't, however, support Dolby Vision which at this price point is disappointing.

This projector truly shines when you have a completely dark room and a pair of speakers that can bring the house down. The picture quality is quite good. The only downside is that HDR content didn't feel as punchy as it did on an OLED TV which can be a tad disappointing. If you are looking for a projector for your home theatre, there are plenty of options to choose from, especially when you consider the ₹3,50,000 price point of the ViewSonic X10. Some of those projectors even bring better HDR performance for the price. However, this projector is also aimed at offering portability and we haven't yet seen a portable projector bring with it support for 4K, HDR along with Wi-Fi and Bluetooth support. Not to mention the sturdy build making it easy and reliable to take this projector on a family trip.

PRICE – ₹3,50,000